

// FIELD SERVICE NERD

PRACTITIONER PRIMER • V1

AI in Field Service.

What's real, what's hype, and where AI actually pays off in
Dynamics 365 Field Service operations.

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How to read this

This is a practitioner's field guide, not a vendor deck. Every claim is written from the perspective of someone who has shipped — and rescued — Dynamics 365 Field Service in production.

Read it in order or jump to the section you're fighting with today. Each section ends with a decision you can actually take back to your team.

DRAFT • V1 OUTLINE

This edition is the structural first cut. The full prose is being written; the skeleton below is the real table of what this primer covers.

The honest state of AI in field service

Separating the demo from the deployment — what AI in field service actually looks like once the pilot ends.

What this section covers

- + The three AI claims vendors make — and which one survives contact with a real operation
- + Where the value actually lands: dispatch, triage, knowledge, and forecasting
- + The "AI theater" tells to watch for in a demo
- + A realistic maturity curve: crawl / walk / run for an AI-assisted service org

Copilot — where it earns its seat

Microsoft Copilot in Field Service: the surfaces that pay off, and the ones that don't yet.

What this section covers

- + Copilot for the dispatcher vs. Copilot for the technician — different jobs, different ROI
- + Work order summarization and recap: real time saved, measured
- + Where Copilot needs clean data to be useful — and what "clean" means here
- + Guardrails: what you must govern before you turn it on

Scheduling & RSO intelligence

The hardest, most valuable problem in field service — and where the intelligence actually ships vs. where it's still a slide.

What this section covers

- + Resource Scheduling Optimization: what it optimizes, and what it can't see
- + Constraints that break the demo: skills, territories, SLAs, travel, parts
- + Why go-live scheduling never matches the sales-cycle scheduling
- + The data and configuration that make optimization trustworthy

IoT-to-work-order: the pattern that holds

Connected Field Service done right — the path from a pinging sensor to a dispatched technician that survives production.

What this section covers

- + The reference pattern: signal → alert → triage → work order → dispatch
- + Avoiding alert storms: thresholds, debouncing, and human-in-the-loop
- + Where AI adds value in the loop (and where it just adds latency)
- + The integration topology that doesn't fall apart at scale

The buyer's checklist

A checklist you can defend to the board before you buy or turn on any AI capability.

What this section covers

- + The questions to ask a vendor that separate shipping from roadmap
- + Data-readiness gates: what must be true before AI is worth it
- + How to pilot without lying to yourself about the results
- + The one-page scorecard

NEXT STEP

Full prose, worked examples, and the printable scorecard land in v2. Get it first — **fieldservicenerd.com**.